

Sujay Shankar

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🌐 github.com/Sujay-Shankar

Education

Boston University

Doctor of Philosophy: Astronomy (in progress)

Sep 2024 – present

GPA: 3.96

The University of Texas at Austin

Aug 2020 – Dec 2023

Bachelor of Science: Astronomy

GPA: 3.8927

Bachelor of Science: Computational Physics

GPA: 3.9058

Certificate: Elements of Computing

GPA: 4.0000

Academic Positions

Boston University | Center for Space Physics | Research Fellow

May 2025 – present

Boston University | Department of Astronomy | Dean's Fellow

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

Boston University | Department of Astronomy | Teaching Fellow

Sep 2024 – Dec 2024

The University of Texas at Austin | Department of Astronomy | Research Engineering/Scientist Assistant

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

University of Florida | Department of Astronomy | REU Student Researcher

May 2023 – Aug 2023

The University of Texas at Austin | McDonald Observatory | Undergraduate Research Assistant

May 2022 – Aug 2023

Publications

1. Shankar, S. et al. 2026 (in prep) *Modeling Fast Magnetic Reconnection in Solar Flare Current Sheets*. ApJ
2. Lu, H.-P. et al. 2026 (in prep) *Common Flare-associated Prominence Eruption on the Active M Dwarf AD Leo*.
3. Shankar, S. & Bandyopadhyay, A. & Ezzeddine, R. 2026 (in prep) *Tagging Globular Cluster Escapee Candidates from APOGEE and GALAH*. ApJ
4. Shankar, S. (in prep) *hydron: A Python interface for launching and post-processing SWMF magnetohydrodynamic simulations*. JOSS
5. Shankar, S. & Gully-Santiago, M. & Morley, C. 2025 *A New Hybrid Machine Learning Method for Stellar Parameter Inference*. ApJ
6. Shankar, S. et al. 2024 *gollum: An intuitive programmatic and visual interface for precomputed synthetic spectral model grids*. JOSS

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Bash, L^AT_EX, Mojo, MATLAB, Swift

Operating Systems: Linux, macOS, Windows

Frameworks & Tools: Pandas, Xarray, Matplotlib, Numpy, Altair, PyTorch, SWMF, Git/GitHub

Contexts: Data Analysis/Visualization, Computational Fluid Dynamics, High-Performance Computing (TACC Frontera, UF HiPerGator, BU SCC, NERSC Perlmutter, NASA HECC Pleiades/Athena), Software Testing and Packaging

Relevant Coursework

AS703 - Intro to Space Physics

AS704 - Cosmic Gas Dynamics

AS708 - Cosmic Plasma Physics

ME547 - Computational Fluid Dynamics

Conferences

2026 SHINE Workshop (<i>upcoming</i>)	June 2026
– Poster: <i>Modeling Fast Magnetic Reconnection in Solar Flare Current Sheets</i>	<i>Madison, WI</i>
American Geophysical Union 2025 (AGU25)	December 2025
– Presentation: <i>Modeling Fast Magnetic Reconnection in Solar Flare Current Sheets</i>	<i>New Orleans, LA</i>
2025 Joint CEDAR/GEM Workshop	June 2025
– Poster: <i>Modeling Magnetic Reconnection in Ionospheric Ejection Current Sheets</i>	<i>Des Moines, IA</i>
American Astronomical Society 243rd Meeting	January 2024
– Poster: <i>Novel Dynamical Tagging of Globular Cluster Escapee Candidates back to their Sources</i>	<i>New Orleans, LA</i>
2023 Bash Symposium	October 2023
– Poster: <i>Precision Fundamental Stellar Properties with Interpetable Machine Learning</i>	<i>Austin, TX</i>

Fellowships & Awards

2026 SHINE Workshop Travel Support Award	2026
Massachusetts Space Grant Consortium Travel Support Award	2025
2025 Joint CEDAR/GEM Workshop Travel Support Award	2025
Boston University Dean's Fellowship	2025
The University of Texas at Austin Department of Astronomy Board of Visitors Scholarship	2023
The University of Texas at Austin University Honors	2021-2023

Leadership, Professional Service, Teaching & Outreach

Boston University Department of Astronomy Graduate Student Representative	2025-2026
URSSI Open Science + Research Software Engineering Summer School Teaching Assistant	2025
Journal of Open Source Software Reviewer	2025
Boston University Department of Astronomy Open Night Volunteer	2024-2025
Boston University Department of Astronomy AS202: Intro to Astronomy Teaching Assistant	2024